

Engineering and Specialized Vehicles

Hobart's Funnies (see pp.116–17) had proven their worth during World War II, and after the war the idea of building specialized vehicles based on a tank chassis became common. Armored Personnel Carriers (APCs) often received this treatment too, with a dizzying array of vehicles developed. These versatile vehicles have been used as mortar carriers, antitank missile launchers, signals vehicles, artillery observation posts, command posts, anti-aircraft missile launchers, and many other roles.

Centurion Armored Vehicle Royal Engineers (AVRE)

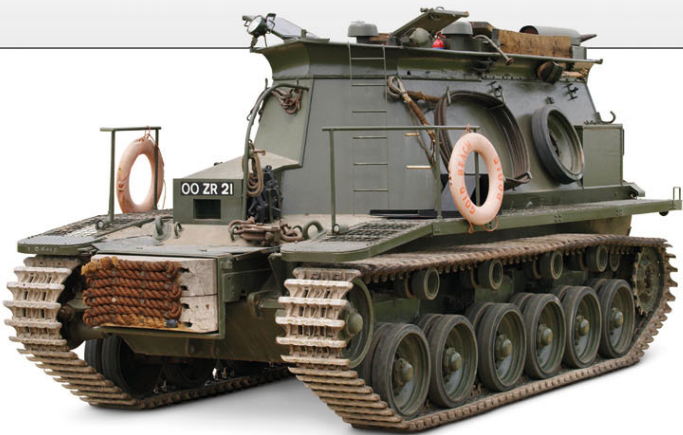
Date	1963	Country	UK
Weight	56 tons (50.8 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce Meteor Mark IVB gasoline, 650 hp		
Main armament	165 mm L9 demolition gun		

The AVRE carried a wide range of equipment to allow engineers to do their work, with similar armor protection and mobility to the standard tank. It was equipped with a dozer blade or a mine plough, and could carry a fascine or a roll of trackway. The AVRE was used in Northern Ireland in 1972 and the Gulf War in 1991.

Centurion BARV

Date	1960	Country	UK
Weight	44.8 tons (40.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce Meteor Mark IVB gasoline, 650 hp		
Main armament	None		

Beach Armored Recovery Vehicles (BARVs) were used to pull vehicles out of the sea, or to push landing craft back in. The Centurion BARV could wade through 9½ ft (2.9 m) of water, although at this depth the driver relied on the commander for guidance. One member of the four-man crew had to be a trained diver.



165 mm main gun used for destroying obstacles



Canvas canopy



M548

Date	1965	Country	USA
Weight	14.8 tons (13.4 tonnes)		
Engine	General Motors Model 6V-53 diesel, 215 hp		
Main armament	.50 Browning M2 machine gun		

An unarmored cargo carrier using the running gear of M113 APC, the M548 was originally intended to carry artillery ammunition and gunners. Its mobility and 6-ton (5.4-tonne) capacity meant it was adapted for a wide range of roles, including launchers for the Chaparral and Rapier surface-to-air missiles. It has seen service in Vietnam, the Yom Kippur War, and the Gulf War.

MT-LB

Date	1970	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	14.7 tons (13.3 tonnes)		
Engine	YaMZ 238 V diesel, 240 hp		
Main armament	7.62 mm PKT machine gun		

The amphibious MT-LB was developed as an armored, all-terrain artillery tractor. It was widely used as a command post vehicle, chemical warfare reconnaissance vehicle, electronic warfare vehicle, and missile carrier. It also saw service as an APC, especially in Arctic regions where its low ground pressure gave it better mobility than other vehicles.